

Teaching Statement

My teaching philosophy is grounded in the belief that effective education empowers students not only with knowledge, but also with the analytical and critical thinking skills necessary to solve real world problems. Economics provides a powerful framework for understanding individual behavior, markets, institutions, and public policy, and my goal as an educator is to help students develop the confidence and skills needed to apply economic reasoning both inside and outside the classroom. Through my experience as a Teaching Assistant in the Department of Economics at Simon Fraser University, I have worked to create learning environments that are inclusive, engaging, intellectually rigorous, and supportive of student success.

A central principle of my teaching is that students learn most effectively when they actively participate in the learning process. Rather than treating economics as a collection of abstract models and equations, I encourage students to engage with economic ideas through discussion, application, and experimentation. In my tutorial sections, I regularly incorporate group discussions, simulations, and problem solving exercises that require students to apply economic theory to contemporary issues. For example, in macroeconomics course, I organized structured group activities in which students analyzed real world economic questions using theoretical concepts and graphical analysis before presenting and defending their conclusions to their peers. These activities strengthened communication and critical thinking skills while helping students recognize the practical relevance of economic theory.

I also believe that students gain a deeper appreciation for economics when they work directly with real world data. To make economic concepts more tangible, I integrate data analysis into my teaching whenever possible. In introductory macroeconomics tutorials, I introduced students to Statistics Canada data and guided them in selecting, interpreting, and presenting economic visualizations. Students explored current economic trends and shared their findings with the class, creating opportunities for discussion and peer learning. These activities helped students develop data literacy skills while demonstrating how economists use evidence to understand and evaluate economic issues.

Another important component of my teaching is clarity and accessibility. Economics can be challenging for students encountering unfamiliar analytical tools for the first time, and I therefore emphasize step by step instruction that builds intuition before introducing more complex applications. In microeconomics, for example, I developed lessons on slopes, budget constraints, and consumer choice, beginning with basic calculations and gradually connecting these tools to economic applications. To reinforce strategic decision making concepts, I incorporated an online Prisoner's Dilemma simulation that allowed students to experiment with different strategies and observe outcomes in an interactive environment. These activities transformed theoretical concepts into experiential learning opportunities and helped students develop a deeper understanding of economic reasoning.

Creating an inclusive and supportive learning environment is equally important to me. Simon Fraser University serves students from diverse educational, cultural, and linguistic backgrounds, and I strive to ensure that all students feel respected, valued, and supported. I maintain regular office hours, offer additional review sessions before midterms and final examinations, and provide individualized support through Canvas and email. I view feedback as a critical component of learning and devote substantial time to helping students understand their mistakes and identify strategies for improvement. By providing detailed feedback and creating opportunities for students to discuss their performance, I aim to build both competence and confidence.

Transparency, consistency, and fairness are fundamental to my teaching practice. As a Head Teaching Assistant, I have coordinated participation and attendance practices across tutorial sections and

developed standardized guidelines to ensure consistency among Teaching Assistants. I believe students perform best when expectations are clearly communicated and assessment practices are applied fairly. By establishing transparent procedures and maintaining open communication, I seek to create an environment in which students can focus on learning and growth.

My commitment to teaching extends beyond my own classroom. Since 2021, I have served as a mentor in the Department of Economics Teaching Assistant Mentorship Program, where I have supported approximately fifteen new Teaching Assistants through teaching consultations, shared grading practices, and ongoing guidance on instructional strategies and student engagement. I have also volunteered regularly in the department's Study Night program, providing academic support to students preparing for final examinations. In addition, I have co-facilitated departmental workshops designed to help new Teaching Assistants transition successfully into their roles. These experiences have reinforced my belief that effective teaching is a collaborative endeavor that extends beyond individual classrooms and contributes to a broader learning community.

My dedication to teaching has been recognized through both student evaluations and departmental awards. I have consistently ranked among the top Teaching Assistants in departmental evaluations and was honored to receive the Terry Heaps Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award and the Faculty of Arts and Social Sciences Employee Achievement Award (Teaching Assistant) in recognition of my contributions to teaching, mentorship, and departmental service. While I am grateful for these recognitions, I view them primarily as evidence of the positive learning environments I strive to create for students and colleagues.

My teaching interests include principles of microeconomics and macroeconomics, intermediate macroeconomics, money and banking, international finance, international trade, public economics, development economics, environmental economics, and applied data analysis. My research interests in macroeconomics, banking, sovereign risk, digital government, and public policy further shape my teaching by allowing me to connect classroom material to contemporary economic challenges and policy debates.

Looking ahead, I am excited by opportunities to contribute to curriculum development and create courses that connect economics to emerging policy challenges and analytical tools. In addition to teaching core economics courses, I would be particularly interested in developing courses on Artificial Intelligence and Economics, Structured and Unstructured Data Analytics for Economists, and Digital Government and Fiscal Capacity. These topics draw naturally on my research and professional experience and would provide students with opportunities to engage with rapidly evolving issues at the intersection of economics, public policy, Artificial Intelligence, and finance.

Ultimately, my goal is to help students become independent thinkers who can use economic reasoning to understand and address complex problems. Through active learning, real world applications, meaningful feedback, and a commitment to student success, I seek to foster a classroom environment in which every student has the opportunity to thrive.